

Chosen Essay: How would you solve the air pollution problem in the Jakarta Metropolitan area?

Air pollution is one of the biggest problems in the Jakarta Metropolitan area. Many people experience unhealthy air almost every day, especially during rush hours when many people commute by car or motorcycle. In my opinion, solving this problem **requires cooperation between the government, companies, and citizens.** The solution should not only focus on one cause because Jakarta's air pollution comes from many sources, such as vehicles, factories, construction activities, and waste burning.

First, the government **should improve public transportation** so it becomes a real alternative to private cars and motorcycles. This is important because transportation is one of the largest contributors to Jakarta's air pollution. According to Vital Strategies and ITB, **motorized vehicles contribute around 32% - 57% of Jakarta's ambient PM2.5 concentration.** Therefore, **MRT, LRT, TransJakarta, and commuter lines should be more connected, affordable, comfortable, and reliable. Public transportation should also reach more residential areas,** so people do not need to travel far just to access a station or bus stop. **The government could also provide 24 - hour public transportation service,** especially on main routes and in busy areas, so people who work late, study late, or travel at night do not have to rely on private vehicles or online transportation. If public transportation becomes more accessible and convenient, more people will choose it, which can reduce traffic congestion and vehicle emissions.

Second, **industries and construction projects must be controlled more strictly** because they are also proven contributors to Jakarta's air pollution. According to the Main Sources of Air Pollution in DKI Jakarta technical brief by Vital Strategies and ITB, **construction activities contributed around 13% of PM2.5 in one Jakarta monitoring area, Kebon Jeruk, during the wet season.** The same study also found that **open burning contributed around 11% of PM2.5 in west and east Jakarta during the wet season and 9% in east Jakarta during the dry season.** In addition, **coal combustion contributed around 14% of PM2.5 in Lubang Buaya during the wet season.** Based on these findings, factories **should be required to use cleaner technology and follow strict emission standards. Construction sites should reduce dust** by covering materials, spraying water when necessary, and cleaning roads around the project area. **Waste burning should also be stopped because it has a measurable impact on air quality.** Citizens need to be educated about proper waste management and the health risks of burning trash.

Finally, **Jakarta needs more green spaces.** Trees and parks cannot solve air pollution completely, but they can help improve air quality and make the city healthier. In conclusion, solving air pollution in Jakarta requires long-term commitment. The most important steps are reducing private vehicle use, controlling industrial and construction pollution, managing waste properly, and creating a greener city. If all parties work together, Jakarta can become a cleaner and healthier place to live.